

Superman (1 of 1)

The author highlights the fact that Indians are so involved with America's history but most people will go a lifetime without ever knowing an Indian or spending time on an Indian reservation, he is highlighting the lack of recognition Indians are receiving despite their efforts. The author wrote this article as a call to action for people to notice their surroundings and learn about the history of Indians because Indians are part of the story that America tells itself, from the first Thanksgiving to the Boston Tea Party up through Crazy Horse, the battle of the Little Bighorn, and Custer's Last Stand. They are so involved in every part of America's history and Americans constantly talk about the events but don't realize that there's always Indians behind the success. The author formatted the article in a way to introduce the Indian reservations to the audience. He described the first paragraph as how life in the reservation is no different as life somewhere else, the difference is the people and "something else". By something else the author was trying to imply how it is also a Indian reservation and then started introducing the locations of where the federally recognized tribes are located. His mood throughout the article is light and comfortable, often sprinkling in irony throughout. For example, the author stated "Some reservations are so small that the sign itself seems larger than the land it denotes." He sets the mood to inform and give people comfort to want to learn more about Indian reservation and go visit them. Then in the fourth paragraph the history of Indians are being used as examples as of how they contributed to teach the audience. "Indians have been disproportionally involved in every war America has fought since its first, including one we're fighting now: on July 27, 2007, the last soldiers of Able Company 2nd-136th Combined Arms battalion returned home to Bemidji, Minnesota, after serving twenty-two months of combat duty in Iraq." The author includes informations that are credible throughout the article since it's his personal anecdote and feelings as an Indian himself and everything he knows about the culture and their contribution. He is speaking out because he thinks Indians aren't getting the proper recognition they deserve after their contributions. They aren't getting the proper count of Indian reservations in the U.S. and most of them need to be federally recognized. Some of the tribes in the U.S. does not get reservations. He stated "There are roughly 310 Indian reservations in the United States, though the Bureau of Indian Affairs (BIA) doesn't have a sure count of how many reservations there are (this might say something about the BIA, or it might say something about the nature of reservations). Not all of the 564 federally recognized tribes in the United States have reservations Some Indian don't have reservations, but all reservations have Indians and all reservations have signs." He is using this article to speak out for all the Indian tribes that aren't getting the proper recognition they deserves.

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In his nonfiction book, David Treuer communicates his message that Native Americans and their communities have contributed to the building of the very foundation of the United States to his readers, and ultimately urges them to realize how important they have been to the development and sustainment of America through the effective use of organization and by alluding to many famous historical people and events.

Throughout the entire excerpt, Treuer utilizes organization to communicate the contribution of Native Americans to the establishment of the United States by starting off with a personal recount of observations about the state of living of Native Americans. For example, he describes the old appearance of cars within reservations and how the children "playing by the road do look different... darker." By doing this Treuer establishes a sense of the community within Indian reserves and sets the picture of how they live. However, he then gradually transitions into the neglect and mistreatment they get. For instance, Treuer remarks that the "BIA doesn't have a sure count of how many reservations there are." This slightly derisive statement introduces his readers to the isolation of Natives in America, and emphasizes the disregard many American organizations have for these reservations and populations of natives. Finally, Treuer uses all this background information in order to make their contributions come as a shock to his readers. He mentions how "Indians contributed to the birth of America itself" through their help within various key American wars and the development of "one of the many models for the American constitution." By introducing these contributions at an almost rapid pace later on in the text, Treuer lets this serve almost as a shock factor to his readers, as it serves to contrast how modern day Indians are largely isolated within their own communities, and live differently from many other Americans who seem to almost disregard them. Understanding all this would move the readers to acknowledge the extent to which the Natives help build the country despite the fact that they live apart from most other American communities that came as a result of European colonization. Therefore, due to the fact that Treuer's effective use of organization creates a sense of shock and stark contrast between modern Indians and their past historical contributions, his readers are ultimately pushed to understand the significant contributions Indians had on the development of American institutions, ideas, and even independence.

Towards the end of the passage, Treuer skillfully utilizes historical allusions in order to communicate his message that Natives have made major contributions to the formations of the United States. For instance, he explains how "the Oneida were allies of the Revolutionary Army who fed U.S. troops at Valley Forge and helped defeat the British," and how "the Iroquois Confederacy served as one of the many models for the American Constitution." He even goes on to allude to a more modern conflict, explaining how Indians served "twenty-two months of combat duty in Iraq." This evidence exemplifies the various significant contributions of the Native Americans because it appeals to the likely American readers' knowledge of key points in American history. Since the readers would likely be largely familiar with the mentioned battles, wars, and other fundamental aspects of the United States, they would come to realize the amount of significance Native Americans really had on the country. Treuer also alludes to key philosophers like Marx and Engels and explains how they stole from the Iroquois "as they developed their theories of communism." Thus, if the readers come to realize just how significantly the Natives have impacted the ideas, development, and

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history of the United States, they would ultimately be urged to have a greater appreciation for the Native Americans and their communities within the United States.

In order to communicate the vastly significant contributions of the Native Americans to the foundation and development of America, Treuer skillfully utilizes organization by contrasting their way of life to their historical significance, and historical allusions by serving to emphasize the variety of events and developments Natives have contributed to that have directly impacted the American way of life.

Black Widow (1 of 1)

The purpose of this passage is to inform readers. Treuer hopes to bring more light into the Native American reservations that most American citizens look over. The main rhetorical device used is Pathos. Readers are able to make this conclusion since the author plays with the emotions: serenity and pity.

Pathos plays a strong hand in this writing piece. Treuer plays into the readers' emotions. He starts off with a gentle description of the differences between American and Native American communities which naturally softens up the audience. As the article progresses, Treuer's tone becomes more and more passionate. There are even some instances where he includes a rather spiteful tone. This tone is especially apparent in paragraph 4, "Indian reservations, and those of us who live on them, are as American as apple pie, baseball, and muscle cars. Unlike apple pie, however, Indians contributed to the birth of America itself." These introductory lines for the fourth paragraph carry a sense of pride in the Native community's participation in the founding of America. However, Treuer also seems to imply that the community doesn't get as much credit as it should. He even attempts to inflict this sense of upset onto the audience with his supporting claims that follow. This sudden change of tone shows how the author hopes for readers to leave the passage with a mirroring passion to his own about the subject.

As for diction, a good majority of it is casual, yet educational. Treuer manages a very friendly and open vibe - as if he's excited to inform others about his heritage. He also manages to use a lot of diction that's easy to understand and explains concepts in a straightforward way. This results in a beneficial outcome since readers are most likely to maintain attention on something that is easily comprehensible to them.

In conclusion, Treuer utilizes a friendly demeanor to spread his purpose. He maintains a constant dynamic with the readers where he seems to be teaching them directly. Once the author thinks he has gained their trust, he starts to inflict more of his passion into his words. This is where the audience receives a strong sense of Pathos from.

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Despite living in this country for countless years, or even being born here, many members of American society have never met or interacted with a Native American before. This is a disappointing fact, as the communities that make up the 564 federally recognized Native American tribes have left an unimaginable impact on the American that we know today. Throughout this excerpt from his nonfiction book *An Indian's Journey Through Reservation Life*, author David Treuer displays this importance of Native Americans in our history through direct historical examples, using second person point of view to address the reader directly, and similes to commonly used phrases.

The contributions to America that have been made by Native Americans go beyond helping early British settlers, and include fighting alongside other Americans in battles as recently as 2007. Treuer includes historical examples of wars fought in part by Native Americans to allow the audience to understand just how great their sacrifice has been. Beyond battles, the author mentions that these communities not only were "allies of the Revolutionary Army who fed U.S. troops at valley", but also stood as "one of the many models for the American constitution", a paper that defined the founding ideals of this country forever. The inclusion of these historical details provides specific details to the readers of his novel, which allows them to better understand and connect with his message of Native American Importance.

During this short five paragraph excerpt, Treuer takes care in making sure the audience is thoroughly engaged in his relaying of Native Americans vital role in our history, and he accomplishes this by using a direct tone with the reader. By utilizing second person language such as "you" or "us", the author effectively brings the reader into their words, and connects them with the meaning of the essay or novel. Instead of simply saying "the signs can be seen from all over America", while referencing the welcome signs for American reservations, Treuer chooses the language "you can see these kinds of signs all over America". While this seemingly insignificant change might be overlooked, the message behind it is one of inclusion for the reader, and in this context is exemplified to show the audience how they have access to connecting with Native Americans all across America. Additionally, this use of direct address of the reader will ultimately drive home his message of how vital the Native Americans are to our America.

Treuer not only displays examples of historical details and direct address of the reader, but also includes the simple rhetorical device of a simile, to compare the Native American communities to a common descriptor. The phrase "as American as apple pie" is one that references the apparent significance of homemade food, such as apple pie. It conjures up the image of what a stereotypical, old fashioned American might look like, including light skin, blond hair, and a sweet demeanor. By referring to Native Americans and their reservations as being "as American as apple pie", he is working against the narrative of what is considered American, and highlighting how these vital communities have worked to shape our nation. By creating this simile, he also is exemplifying how there is nothing more American than those that were here long before European settlers, and who fight alongside us to this day.

The way in which Native American contributions have been consistently overlooked is something that our Nation should not be proud of. From assisting our troops in the

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Revolutionary war to our most recent one, Native Americans have consistantly changed what our nation looks like, and how we live in it. This is a fact that should be overlooked no longer, so that we may one day embrace their status as true Americans.

ant man (1 of 1)

In the excerpt from David Treuer's nonfiction book, Treuer uses imagery and diction to highlight that Native Americans and Indian reservations had a huge impact in North American society.

Batman (1 of 2)

David Treuer, an Indian novelist who grew up on a Minnesota reservation, argues that Americans should pay more attention to Indians and put forth more effort in understanding their livelihoods. Using rhetorical techniques, Treuer does this by first comparing and contrasting reservations with non-reservation land, then describing reservations more in depth, and finally describing the importance of Indians in American history.

In order to convey his argument to Americans that they should work towards understanding Indian life, Treuer begins by comparing the land most Americans are familiar with to reservation lands. He states that the sign welcoming travelers into the reservation "is soon behind you and soon forgotten" (Treuer 2). This anaphora with the repetition of "soon" emphasizes the fact that non-Indians entering a reservation typically ignore the fact that they have entered such a place and fail to acknowledge the meaning behind where they are located. This serves to show the audience that their ignorance is noticeable, effectively setting up the argument that they should pay more attention to the meaning of Indian life. Continuing, Treuer states that "The houses don't look all that different [on the reservations], perhaps a little smaller, a little more ramshackle" (2). The words "smaller" and "ramshackle" describe a setting that seems in worse shape than in non-reservations. This comparison further demonstrates a degree of ignorance toward reservation life, serving as a way to familiarize the audience with an unfamiliar and often overlooked setting, again setting up the main issue of ignorance in the passage.

Treuer continues this passage by describing reservation life more in depth in order to describe the conditions and livelihoods of Indians on reservations. He states that "...all reservations have signs... you can see these signs in more than thirty of the states" (Treuer 3). The repetition of the word "signs" expresses to the audience that the resources are there for them to learn more about reservations and actually pay attention to their existence. However, as the passage as a whole demonstrates, the audience generally ignores their existence, showing just how much of an unknown problem this ignorance is. Treuer continues his description of reservations, stating that "Some reservations are so small that the sign itself seems larger than the land it denotes" (3). This hyperbole emphasizes the difference in sizes of the reservations, showing how similar they are to the land that most other Americans are accustomed to (with the fact that they all differ). This allows the audience to reflect on their attention to Indian reservations and have more of an inside look at reservation life, making them question whatever assumptions they may have had.

Finally, Treuer establishes his argument that Americans should pay more attention to reservation life by expressing the importance of Indians in American history. He states that "The Oneida were allies of the Revolutionary Army who fed U.S. troops at Valley Forge and helped defeat the British in New York" (Treuer 4). This allusion to the Revolutionary War (which eventually led to the independence of the American colonies) shows just how important Indians are in the establishment of the country now known as the United States. This enables the audience to reflect on how they have been ignorant toward Indian culture and livelihood, persuading them that they should pay more attention and do more research regarding the matter. Treuer also uses personification, stating that "Indians are part of the

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story that America tells itself" (5). This shows how Americans do acknowledge Indians but often have a false narrative.

In conclusion, David Treuer establishes his argument that Americans must pay more attention to reservation life and the role of Indians in America by comparing American lands to reservations, explaining the characteristics of reservations, and describing the importance of Indians in American history.